

"You are more than aware I do not approve of when you bring those... *things* up here," drolled Her Majesty, the Most Magnificent Queen of the Split Stratosphere.

The Just Tyrant dropped the tangled ball of limbs and wire on the floor, where it writhed and pulsated.

"'Tis harmless!" he insisted. "'Tis but a wee one! I pulled its wretched form atom by atom from the inky black nothing, and transformed its incorporeal maybe into a definitely! Is not it the greatest representation of the righteously sanctioned work I toil at?"

Her Majesty cocked an eyebrow and grimaced.

"There be a fine line between reality and un-reality for a stupendous reason, great Tyrant of Ontology," she spoke with little effort to conceal her disapproval. She tapped a finger on her chin, an old habit, leaving a fingerprint on her omnicolorful makeup.

"A line I govern! If I want it real, I make it real; and just as soon as that, life given can be a life taken," and with that he dropped his heavy blade, the weight of a neutron star, and it cleaved the pitiful mass beneath him into two, where it rapidly disintegrated into its basest components and soon became no more.

"Your delight in small games of cruelty sicken me."

"Your complacency to sit on a throne makes me laugh."

Deep below, below them in the violet-obsidian antechamber they argued in, a horrible vortex swirled below, churning and groaning and exploding and crying, smashing particles together and ripping them apart. A machine with no parts, a machination of no design.

The floor of Her Majesty's royal observatory was made of the purest quartz, a quartz so pure that it gave a better image of what you could see through it than the naked eye. Through this glass quartz floor, the vortex's white-hot incorporeal eye watched the argument.

"I sit on the throne because the world must be watched. The vortex is angry, and its fury only grows. If it leaves"

"Furies are sated by action, madam! Each day I pull something new from inside, and I slay it. Think of it, if you would my lady, as a great angry beehive! One by one I remove the larvae, and crush them to pulp. It is slow, it is tedious, and it is just!"

"You say this, but does the vortex ever shrink? Despite all your efforts and rage, does it not only grow? Perhaps the only furies being sated by action are your own, but like a gluttonous engine of sin, it never empties! An infected wound, it never heals!

"When you hurt the vortex, perhaps only then it grows! A deluge of pain, you can summon life from it. But the life it gives is only dark, and twisted, much like yourself. You've never brought anything of meaning into this world. You are like antimatter, you invent negative space wherever you go.

"And antimatter, my dear Tyrant, explodes on contact with what is real."

"Uh, guys, am I going to have to call a recess?" asked the nervous and somewhat neurotic Dungeon Master, Todd, who was overseeing game night that weekend.

June stared down her husband, who stared back with that old familiar half-grin that reeked of false confidence.

No one had rolled any dice in a while. Given the Feats on their Character Sheets, the characters of June and her husband were able to achieve much without ever needing to roll.

The other players at the table were in various states of displeasure or disinterest. No one liked playing with The Just Tyrant or Her Majesty, because they always made it about them.

One player, a portly ginger whom you couldn't quite tell was ginger, was on her phone. Another player, hair white as snow and skin dark as obsidian, doodled on scratch paper. This evidently was not a new occurrence.

"I hate you so much," June said to her husband.

The Tyrant whisked this vision into the air through sheer willpower alone, visible like a gaseous cloud spreading through the room.

"Our quarrel for the vortex be much like this mundane scene of marital dispute in one of the lesser realms, in which they antagonize the lives of their friends by leaking their own hatred for each other into the world around them," he explained.

"Don't bother me with such small and trivial matters as what one reality has to say. One day, I will teach you the proper ways of the cosmos," replied Her Majesty of Everything, and with an exaggerated bow The Just Tyrant took his leave.